

Wang Fuk Court Fire Inquiry: the record is public, the answers are hard to find

A citizen-built, machine-readable companion to the Independent Committee's published record

To	Members of the Panel on Security, Legislative Council of Hong Kong
From	Wenyun Fu, Lucia Luo and Simon Wang (Wang Fuk Court Fire Report project)
Date	10 October 2026
Subject	Accessibility of the inquiry record ahead of the Committee's final report, due by end of October 2026

1 • Why we are writing

Dear Members,

The Independent Committee on the Wang Fuk Court fire has published its entire evidentiary record — 243 documents, 6,377 pages, some 1.9 million words. We do not question the completeness of that publication; we question its accessibility. The material is filed by the sequence of the Committee's work, not by the seven questions in its Terms of Reference. A resident asking "*was the renovation tender rigged?*" or "*why did the alarms fail?*" cannot obtain an answer from the government's own search box — and never could.

We are a volunteer group of educators and researchers. With open-source tools and AI we rebuilt the whole record: crawled every document, converted all PDFs to searchable text, read the scanned documents by OCR, and tagged every document against the Committee's seven Terms of Reference. The result is a free, bilingual public website (link and QR code below). Most importantly, reading the full text rather than summaries changed the picture dramatically:

11 → 99

documents relevant to bid-rigging and collusion, summary reading vs. full-text reading

8 → 77

documents on the adequacy of laws and penalties (ToR 6)

85

shutdown-renewal notices filed by a contractor who never visited the estate

168

lives lost — the record owes the public at least findability

2 • What this shows

None of the documents described above uses the words "bid-rigging" or "collusion". The evidence residents most want is in oral subcontracts, rubber-stamped inspections and notices filed without a single site visit. It is invisible to keyword search and unreachable through the archive's own structure. The lesson is general: **publication is not accessibility; transparency is not scrutiny**. A machine-readable, question-organised record — achievable at low cost with routine tools — is what turns a public archive into public knowledge.

3 • Our asks of the Panel

1. **Brief the Panel.** Invite the Security Bureau and the Fire Services Department to present the Committee's findings and recommendations as soon as the report is published, and table the report to the Panel.
2. **Fix the shutdown regime.** Ask how shutdowns and restorations of fire service installations will in future be verified by physical inspection — 85 renewal notices were filed with no site visit.
3. **Contractor accountability.** Ask what mechanisms can suspend or debar contractors implicated in the inquiry pending prosecutions.
4. **A public implementation timetable** for the Committee's recommendations, including legislative amendments under its third Term of Reference, with progress reported back to the Panel.
5. **Present the record by Terms of Reference** — so members and the public can trace each recommendation to the underlying evidence, and future inquiries publish machine-readable text alongside their PDFs.

4 • Access the interactive record

The complete reorganised record — every document summarised and searchable, seven Terms-of-Reference narratives, and this briefing — is live at:

<https://wangfukcourtfirereport.simonsays.hk/engagement/legcoDraft.html>

The page is kept current as the inquiry's final report approaches; the QR code below always points to the latest version.



Scan to open the live briefing

5 · Signatories

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